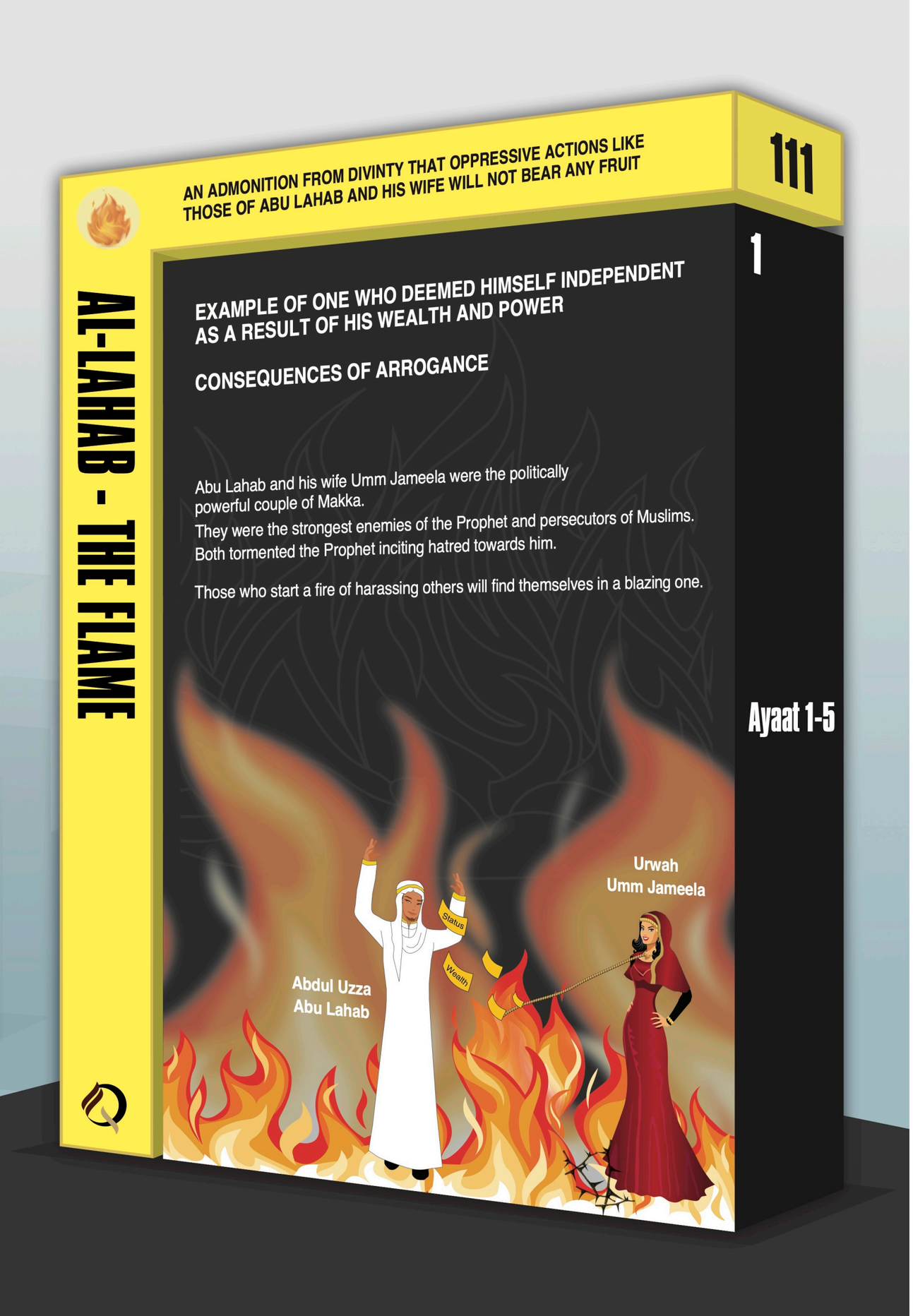

111. Al-Lahab ~ The Flame

5 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

AN ADMONITION FROM DIVINTY THAT OPPRESSIVE ACTIONS LIKE THOSE OF ABU LAHAB AND HIS WIFE WILL NOT BEAR ANY FRUIT

DID YOU KNOW?

THE SURA IS ALSO CALLED AL MASAD (A ROPE OF PALM FIBRE). IT REFERS TO THE WIFE OF ABU LAHAB (UMM JAMEELA) WHO USED TO WEAR A PRECIOUS RED NECKLACE. SHE WOULD SAY SHE WOULD GLADLY GIVE IT TO DESTROY THE PROPHET.

SELECTED AYAAT

111:1 The power in the hands of Abu Lahab will perish as will he
111:2 His wealth nor what he has earned will avail him
111:3 Soon he will enter a blazing fire
111:4 And his wife, the wood carrier
111:5 Around her neck is a rope of palm fibre

NARRATIVE

ABU LAHAB, THE FATHER OF FLAMES, AND HIS WIFE ARE USED AS AN EXAMPLE OF PEOPLE WHO BELIEVED THAT THEY WERE INDEPENDENT OF GOD, HE HAD WEALTH, POWER, ARROGANCE AND A TONGUE AS HOT AND SHARP AS FLAMES.

THEY USED THIS TO TORMENT THE PROPHET AND DESTROYED THEMSELVES IN THE PROCESS, TEACHING THAT BY STARTING A FIRE HARASSING OTHERS, ONE CAN FIND ONESELF IN ONE'S OWN FIRE AND NEITHER WEALTH NOR POWER WILL ASSIST.